

As an adult, I had never given it much thought until a comedian I was listening to pointed out that even hard-nosed conservationists seem to forget their scruples in the stall. Why use a few sheets when a massive wad of paper will do the job just as well?

My mother worked out, pretty quickly, that regardless of how good the toilet paper was that she bought, we'd use the same amount: way too much. So instead of buying the luxurious double rolls with extra absorbency, she'd get standard rolls. And as kids, we never really noticed the difference, and would still pull armfuls of paper from the roll, leaving the cardboard tube spinning on the holder for a good 10 seconds.

So, what to do? Pardon the pun, but even to a frugal guy like me it seems a little anal to have a toilet paper strategy. I mean, I don't have much of a life but I'm not at the point where I'm counting TP sheets . . . at least, not yet. But there are a few things I can suggest, especially with kids around.

### 1. Skip the luxury

Think twice about getting those expensive, luxurious rolls of paper for the kids' bathroom. Regular paper works just as well, and kids will use either one with zeal.

### 2. Try baby wipes

Consider having a box of baby wipes in the bathroom. For those times when things get a little messy (stomach flu, anyone?), a baby wipe or two will do the work of handfuls of toilet paper. They're designed to handle much bigger messes than regular TP. Of course, buy *flushable* wipes if you're flushing them along with the regular TP.

### 3. Buy standard-sized rolls

Double rolls actually run down quicker than two standard rolls. The reason being, we see more of the roll and subconsciously use more because there's plenty. It's the reason you keep seeing manufacturers up the size of the roll, so that now we need extra equipment to fit these jumbo-sized rolls onto the holder.

### 4. Go with store brand

There is very little difference, if any, between name-brand and store brand; especially in this instance when it all ends up being flushed down the drain anyway.

### 5. Practice restraint

There's no reason to attack the roll and pull masses of paper away